

Michaela Sterzinger

Frontend Development for Designers – Portfolio Case Study

 michaela-sterzinger.github.io/portfolio-website

Overview

Project: UX/UI Design & Frontend Portfolio Website

Timeline: 2 months

As a UX/UI designer aiming to expand my skillset into frontend development, I created a fully responsive, accessible, and performant portfolio website from scratch using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. The project was part of the Frontend Development for Designers course and challenged me to bridge the gap between design and development.

By combining user-centered design with frontend coding, I gained a deeper understanding of how design decisions translate into code—an essential skill to better collaborate with developers and even take on frontend tasks myself in future roles.

Context and Challenges

The Frontend Development for Designers Course was structured into 2 achievements and 14 assignments, covering:

- Introduction to HTML, CSS, and JavaScript
- GitHub workflows and hosting
- Mobile-first and responsive design
- Testing and accessibility practices
- Final site deployment

The timeline spanned several weeks, with each assignment building upon the last to gradually construct the final portfolio site.

The Problem & Goals

Problem

As a designer, I wanted to deepen my understanding of frontend development and immerse myself in the role, as my knowledge in this area was quite basic.

Goals

- Build a real, working website
- Understand how frontend development works and what positive effects it can have for me to take this into account in the design process
- Stay in the UX/UI Design role, but expand into frontend development

The Process

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Git & GitHub

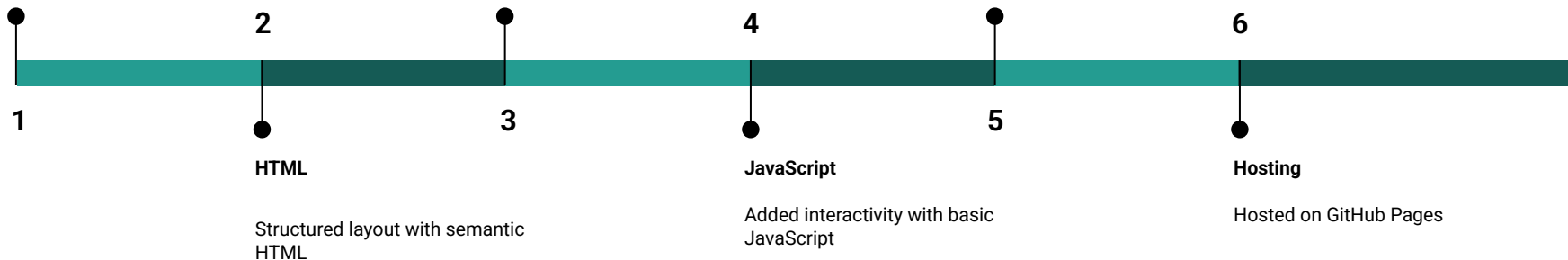
Used Git & GitHub for version control and hosting

CSS

Styled with CSS Flexbox, Grid & Media Queries

Testing

User testing for feedback, Accessibility checks, Cross-browser testing



Insights

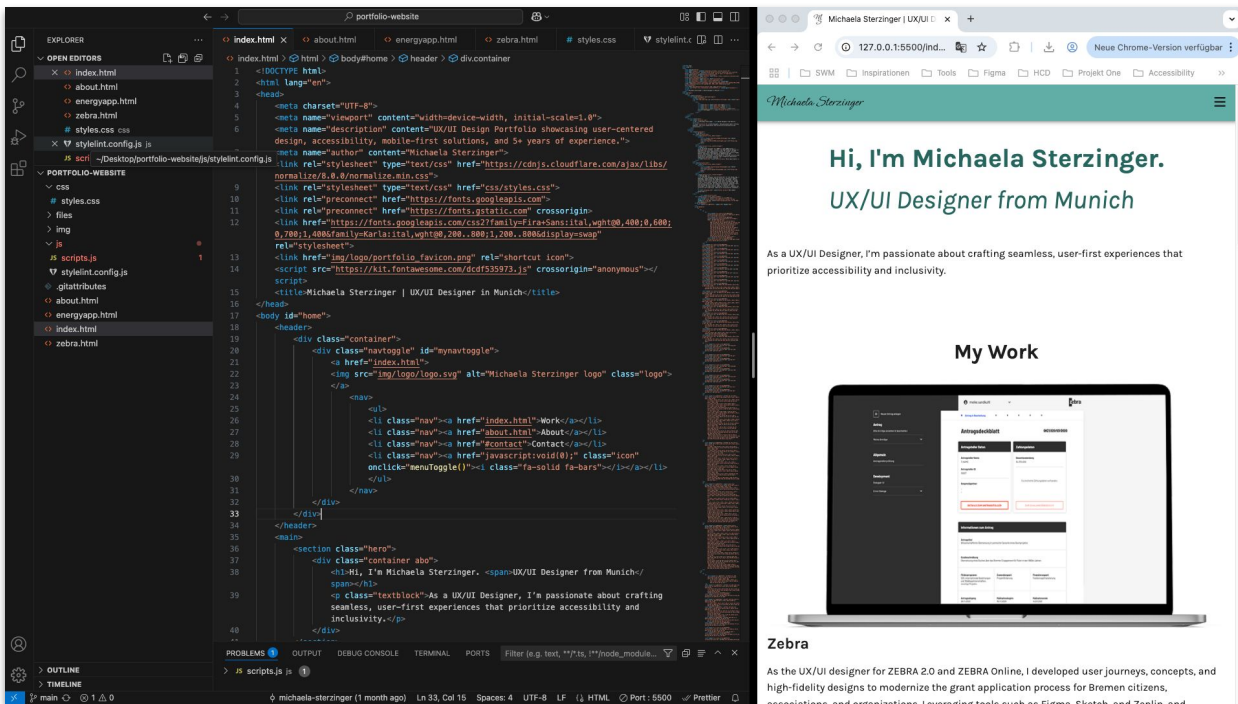


Solution

- ★ Responsive layout with mobile-first approach
- ★ Semantic HTML for accessibility
- ★ Clear and intuitive navigation
- ★ Custom design reflecting personal brand



Portfolio Website - Visual Studio Code

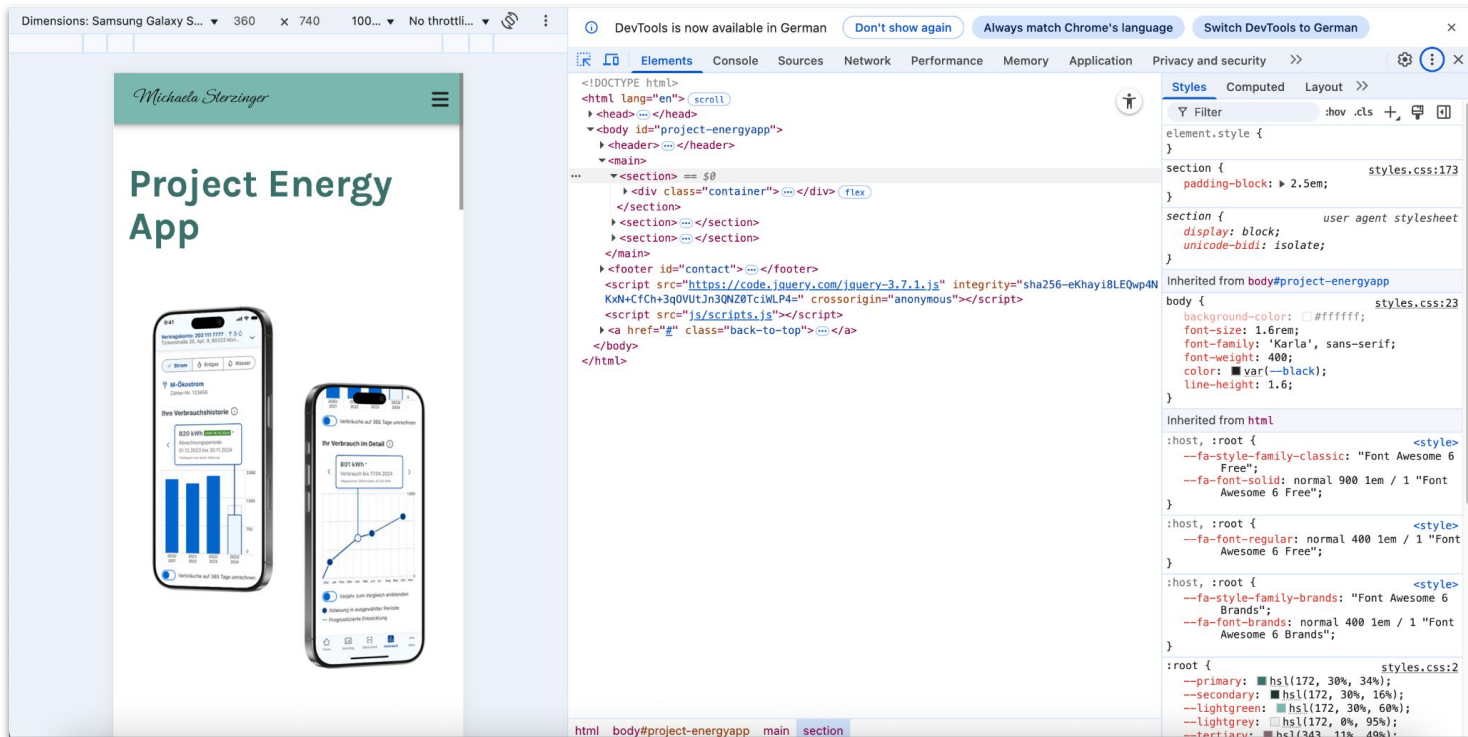


Portfolio Website – Mobile First

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Portfolio Website – Check



Results

✓ Live website launched:
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✓ Practical skills in HTML, CSS, JS

✓ Stronger collaboration with dev teams for the future

✓ Design decisions better informed by frontend logic

✓ Confident in bridging design and frontend development

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Contact

Michaela Sterzinger

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About Me



My Story

As a UX/UI designer, I bring a unique blend of creativity, empathy, and technical expertise to every project. My background in Technical Writing and Communication (Bachelor's degree) and Interactive Media Systems with a focus on Mobile Experience (Master's degree) has equipped me with the tools to craft user-centered, accessible designs that solve real-world problems. Over the past 5+ years, I've gained professional experience working in startups, agencies, and corporations, where I honed my ability to design intuitive and impactful user experiences.

In addition to my design expertise, I have acquired knowledge in front-end development using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, which enhances my ability to collaborate effectively with developers and understand the implementation process. My approach to design is rooted in a human-centered philosophy, leveraging tools like Figma, Sketch, and Zeplin, as well as techniques such as usability testing, prototyping, and accessibility-focused design. What sets me apart is my passion for inclusivity and accessibility. By combining my technical communication background, mobile-first design expertise, and front-end development knowledge, I am dedicated to creating seamless, meaningful user experiences that empower and connect people. I thrive in dynamic environments, working collaboratively with cross-functional teams to deliver solutions that truly make a difference.

Outside of work, I'm an optimistic and humorous person who loves staying active and adventurous. My personal interests include bouldering, inline skating, beach volleyball, snowboarding, hiking, and exploring new cultures through travel. I also enjoy spending time outdoors with my dog, who is my loyal companion on my adventures. These passions not only fuel my creativity but also inspire me to

Skills & Tools

Relevant Skills

- UX/UI Design
- Accessible & Inclusive Design
- Human Centered Design Approach
- Usability Research & Testing
- Prototyping
- HTML, CSS & JavaScript
- Problem Solving
- Storytelling and Empathy in Design
- Working in Dynamic and agile Environments

Tools I use

- Figma
- Sketch
- Zeplin
- VSCode
- Jira
- Confluence